

- **Lesson A How's the Weather?**
 - Listening
 - Conversation
- **Lesson B Sunshine and Happiness**
 - Listening 1
 - Listening 2
 - Oral Practice
- **Listening Skills**

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 **beach** n. A beach is an area of sand and small stones by the sea. 沙滩

Costa Rica 哥斯达黎加

 **San José** 圣何塞 (哥斯达黎加首都)

 **tourist** n. A tourist is a person who is visiting a place for pleasure. 游客, 观光者

Listen to the recording once and choose the best answer.



1. The speaker mainly talks about _____ Costa Rica.
a. the wildlife in ☒ b. the best time to visit c. the history of
2. How many seasons does Costa Rica have?
a. one ☒ b. two c. three

New words and expressions A. Listening for gist B. Listening for details

1. Listen to the recording again. Complete the table below using the words in the box. Some words may be used more than once.



cloudy cold cooler dry hot rains sunny warm

Months	How's the weather?
May-June	Mornings: It's <u>cloudy</u> and <u>warm</u> . Afternoons and evenings: It <u>rains</u> , sometimes a lot.
July-August	West coast: It's <u>dry</u> and <u>hot</u> ; it <u>rains</u> at night.
February-April	At the beach: It's <u>sunny</u> and <u>hot</u> . In San José: It's <u>cooler</u> . In the mountains: It's <u>cold</u> at night.

New words and expressions A. Listening for gist B. Listening for details

2. Decide whether the following statements are true (T) or false (F).



- ☐ F 1) June is the start of the rainy season.
- ☐ T 2) It's not always easy to travel in Costa Rica.
- ☐ F 3) In June, the west coast is mostly dry and hot.
- ☐ F 4) The most popular time to visit Costa Rica is December.

Listen to the conversation and practice with a partner by using the words on the right. Then change partners and practice again.



External Player



Script



Language Note



A: We have a holiday next month.

Let's go somewhere.

B: Sounds good. Where?

A: What about **Jamaica**?

the Philippines

New Zealand

Sweden

B: How's the weather there now?

A: It's **24** degrees and **sunny**.

33 / raining

3 / snowing

minus 8 / windy

B: **Perfect!**

That's too hot. Let's go somewhere else

Great! We can go skiing

That's too cold for me



Keywords



Practice



Language Note

The question ***How's the weather there now?*** asks about the general weather condition at the present time of year. In this case, ***now*** is similar in meaning to ***these days***.

Part II Listening and Speaking / Lesson B Listening 1

A. New words and expressions B. Pre-listening questions C. Listening comprehension

How do you feel in different kinds of weather? Complete the sentences using the feelings in the box.   

 calm	 relaxed	 cranky	 energetic	 happy
 lazy	 sad	 blue	 sleepy	 tired

1. When it's **cold** and **cloudy**, I feel energetic/sad/sleepy/blue.
2. When it's **raining**, I feel sad/blue/lazy/energetic.
3. When it's **sunny** and **warm**, I feel energetic/happy/calm.
4. When it's **very hot**, I feel lazy/sleepy/tired/cranky.

Ask your partner the questions and have a discussion.

What's the weather like in your hometown?

Can you describe the typical weather in your hometown?



Exercise 1: Listening for gist. Listen to the recording once and answer the following question.



What is the main idea of the passage?



People relax in a park in London. Sunlight can make you happier, say scientists.

Exercise 2. Listening for details.

1. Listen again. Decide whether the following statements are true (T) or false (F).



- ☒ T 1) Sunny days make us happy.
- ☒ T 2) Low serotonin levels will make you feel tired and sad.
- ☐ F 3) In hot weather we think fast and clearly.
- ☐ F 4) The higher the temperature is, the happier we are.
- ☐ F 5) We all work better on cold days.

Exercise 2. Listening for details.

2. Choose the correct answer for each sentence.



- 1) On a sunny day, most people feel (**happy** / **lazy**) because warm, sunny weather (**relaxes us** / **makes us less energetic**).
- 2) On a hot day we think more (**quickly** / **slowly**), so it is (**easier** / **harder**) to think clearly.
- 3) On rainy days, some people are (**more** / **less**) energetic, so they (**work better** / **feel more lazy**).
- 4) On cloudy or rainy days, the amount of serotonin in our body (**increases** / **decreases**). This can make us feel (**tired or blue** / **happier and more energetic**).



 **lamp** *n.* 灯



 **liter** *n.* 升 (容量单位)

natural *adj.* existing in nature 自然的

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Listen to the recording and give answers to the following question.



What is the speaker talking about?

She is giving some advice about what we can do in certain types of weather.

Part II Listening and Speaking / Lesson B Listening 2

New words and expressions A. Listening for gist B. Listening for details

1. Listen again. Read the ideas under 1) and 2). Check the ideas you hear.



1) When it's hot . . .

- ☐ take a shower.
- ☒ eat some ice cream.
- ☒ have a cold drink.

2) On a cold winter's day . . .

- ☒ walk outside in the morning.
- ☐ have a hot drink.
- ☒ use a bright lamp.

Reason

- a. It makes you feel cooler.
- b. Sunlight makes you feel happier.
- c. It makes you feel warmer.
- d. It increases your energy.
- e. It's similar to sunlight.

2. Draw lines to match the ideas in 1) and 2) with reasons. One reason is extra.

New words and expressions A. Listening for gist B. Listening for details

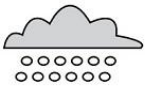
3. Complete the advice with the words you hear.



Eat or drink something cold and sweet when it's hot, because your body can lose a liter of water every hour. A cold drink returns water to the body. On a cold winter's day, go outside and walk for thirty minutes in the morning. Being in the sunlight can make you feel happier. If you can't go outside, sit near a bright lamp for thirty minutes while you work or study.

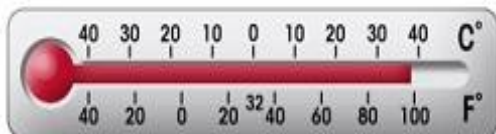


Talk about the weather

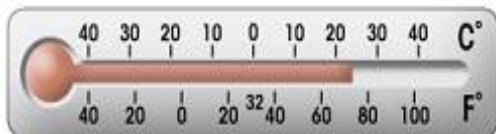
	Noun	Adjective	Verb	
	a cloud	cloudy	—	It's cloudy / sunny today.
	rain	rainy	rain	It's raining / snowing today.
	snow	snowy	snow	It rains / snows a lot in the winter.
	sun	sunny	—	The sun is shining today.
	wind	windy	—	The wind is blowing really hard this morning. It's usually windy in the spring.

A. Important language B. Discussion

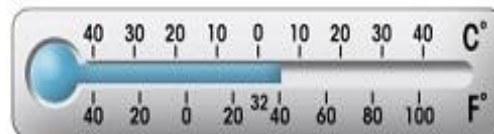
hot



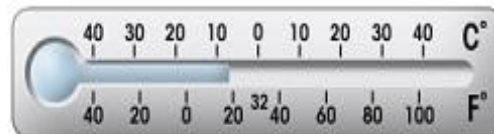
warm



cool



cold



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Asking how someone is.

Student A: Imagine you have a problem with the weather. Tell your partner.

Student B: Your partner seems unhappy. Ask how he or she is. Make a suggestion. Use the expressions below.

Hey, Mario. **Are you okay?**

Yeah? **What's wrong?**

Go work in the library.
There's A/C there.

Not really.

I have a lot of work to do, but
it's too hot!

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Recognizing the Weak Forms of Unstressed Words

Structural words, such as **prepositions**, **conjunctions**, **auxiliaries** and **articles** are often **pronounced in their weak forms** in spoken English unless emphasis is needed. Here are some examples of them:

a, an, am, and, are, as, at, be, been, but, can, could, do, does, for, from,

had, has, have, he, her, him, is, me, of, shall, she, should, some,

than, that, them, these, to, us, was, etc.

It's important to learn how to use the weak forms of unstressed words. Learners who are not familiar with the use of weak forms are likely to have difficulty in understanding native speakers. Use the following examples to practice **stressed words (underlined)** and **unstressed words**.

e.g. *We're at school.*

“School” is pronounced in its strong form because it’s a stressed word. “We’re” and “at” are pronounced in their weak form because they are unstressed words.

e.g. *The meeting is at one.*

This is for you.

Is that your car?

Left or right?

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Sometimes, a content word may also be unstressed if it is placed between two strongly stressed words. In these situations, we pronounce words according to their weak forms.

Listen to the recording and fill in the blanks with what you hear. Notice that the weak forms of words often contain the vowel /ə/ and the vowel /i:/ is often pronounced as /ɪ/.



External Player



Script



1. Let me take a quick look at your application.
2. To tell you the truth, I need a part-time job, both for money and experience.
3. To my mind, teaching is an honorable job.
4. We're supposed to look our best at an interview.
5. I don't think you can handle both a part-time job and your schoolwork.
6. I'd like to find a job as a secretary.

Listen to the recording and fill in the blanks with what you hear. Notice that the weak forms of words often contain the vowel /ə/ and the vowel /i:/ is often pronounced as /ɪ/.

7. In my opinion, the competition in the job market is quite intense nowadays.
8. Many students in the West take part-time jobs to get some working experience for their future career.
9. As far as I'm concerned, working as a tourist guide is fun.
10. In any job application it is required that you submit at least two recommendation letters written by your teachers or employers.